

SYLLABUS, VERBATIM

'Quine and Strawson : Critique of Empiricism; Theory of Basic
Particulars and Persons.'

NOTE: the paper prints a space before the colon. Preserve it ONLY
inside a verbatim quotation of the syllabus.

|

THE TWO LIMBS DIVIDE CLEANLY - ONE OWNER EACH

LIMB 1 CRITIQUE OF EMPIRICISM QUINE 1908-2000
two dogmas, failed explications of analyticity,
reductionism, confirmation holism, revisability, and
empiricism without the dogmas

LIMB 2 THEORY OF BASIC PARTICULARS
AND PERSONS STRAWSON 1919-2006
descriptive metaphysics, identification and
re-identification, the public spatio-temporal framework,
material bodies, and the person as a primitive concept

|

THE ONE MOVE THE CLAUSE MAKES

CLASSICAL AND LOGICAL EMPIRICISM MADE TWO PROMISES:

- (i) every meaningful sentence can be sorted into TRUE BY MEANING
and TRUE BY FACT, and checked against experience ONE AT A TIME
- (ii) the world can be rebuilt out of PRIVATE SENSORY GIVENS

QUINE breaks (i) FROM INSIDE EMPIRICISM.

STRAWSON shows (ii) CANNOT EVEN GET STARTED.

FATAL OPENING: 'The Quine-Strawson critique of empiricism holds that ...'

THEY ARE NOT ALLIES. THE ONLY DOCUMENTED EXCHANGE IS A DISAGREEMENT.
GRICE AND STRAWSON, 'IN DEFENCE OF A DOGMA',
The Philosophical Review, 1956.
CO-AUTHORED with H. P. GRICE. British spelling: DEFENCE.
They defend the ANALYTIC/SYNTHETIC DISTINCTION that Quine
attacked in 1951.

|
THE TWO PROJECTS, SIDE BY SIDE

+-----+-----+	
QUINE	STRAWSON
LEVEL the THEORY OF	LEVEL the STARTING POINT
CONFIRMATION	
MOVE both dogmas fail;	MOVE identification needs
sentences face	re-identification,
experience only as a	which needs ONE public
CORPORATE BODY	spatio-temporal
	framework
TOOL logic + naturalism +	TOOL connective conceptual
behavioural evidence	analysis, TRANSCEN-
	DENTAL IN FORM
RESULT EMPIRICISM WITHOUT THE	RESULT MATERIAL BODIES and
DOGMAS - he STAYS an	PERSONS are BASIC in
empiricist	our conceptual scheme
+-----+-----+	

|
THE ONLY LEGITIMATE JOINT SENTENCE
Empiricism failed TWICE OVER: about how theories are CONFIRMED
(Quine) and about how we so much as REFER (Strawson).
That is a PROBLEM-FIELD, not a shared thesis.

9 PRIMARY-OWNED QUESTION-PARTS OUT OF 112.

QUINE - FIVE PARTS		STRAWSON - FOUR PARTS	
2018 Q2(c)	15m a priori as 'article of faith'	2018 Q1(e)	10m concept of person
2019 Q1(e)	10m against the synthetic- analytic distinction	2020 Q3(b)	15m spatio-temporal thinking and basic particulars
2021 Q3(c)	15m empiricism without the dogmas	2021 Q3(b)	15m material bodies AND persons as basic particulars
2024 Q4(c)	15m nature of the two dogmas	2023 Q4(a)	20m person as primitive; implication for mind-body dualism
2025 Q4(b)	15m 'affirm the truth of any sentence ...'	THE ONLY 20-MARKER IN THE CLAUSE IS STRAWSON'S, IN 2023.	

YEAR DISTRIBUTION

2018 TWO | 2019 one | 2020 one | 2021 TWO | 2022 NONE
2023 one | 2024 one | 2025 one

CONSEQUENCE: frequent but NOT guaranteed. Prepare it to ANSWER, not to recognise. DECIDE THE OWNER FROM THE STEM BEFORE WRITING A LINE.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/42: THE OWNERSHIP FENCE - WHAT IS NOT OWNED HERE

VERIFICATION PRINCIPLE, AYER, CARNAP'S AUFBAU,
THE VIENNA CIRCLE as DOCTRINE Topic 07 Logical Positivism
(here ONLY as the position Quine dismantles)

HUME'S IMPRESSIONS AND IDEAS, THE BUNDLE
SELF, THE PROBLEM OF INDUCTION as DOCTRINE Topic 03 Empiricism

KANT'S SYNTHETIC A PRIORI, THE TRANSCENDENTAL
DEDUCTION, THE ANTINOMIES as DOCTRINE Topic 04 Kant
(here ONLY through the 2018 framing and Strawson's affinity)

RUSSELL'S THEORY OF DESCRIPTIONS as DOCTRINE Topic 06 Moore-Russell-
Early Wittgenstein
(here ONLY as the rival 'On Referring' answers)

MEANING AS USE, LANGUAGE-GAMES, THE PRIVATE
LANGUAGE ARGUMENT as DOCTRINE Topic 08 Later Wittgenstein
(here ONLY as a bounded comparison)

STRAWSON ON FREEDOM, RESENTMENT AND THE
REACTIVE ATTITUDES ('Freedom and
Resentment', 1962) BOUNDED / CROSS-OWNED.
NOT a printed limb. NOT PYQ-OWNED 2018-2025. One clause maximum.

STRAWSON ON INDUCTION (1952) AND ON KANT
(1966) bounded enrichment only

PERSONAL IDENTITY OVER TIME, THE SOUL,
IMMORTALITY Paper II

BOUNDED QUINE ENRICHMENT - TAUGHT IN FULL, USED AFTER THE PRINTED BURDEN
ontological commitment | radical translation and gavagai |
inscrutability | indeterminacy | ontological relativity |
naturalized epistemology
NOT independently printed and NOT PYQ-owned in 2018-2025.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/42: PROVENANCE RAIL, PART ONE - 1905 TO 1953

- 1905 RUSSELL, 'On Denoting'. The theory of descriptions.
Topic 06's property; the position 'On Referring' answers.
- 1906 DUHEM, La Theorie physique: son objet, sa structure.
Eng. The Aim and Structure of Physical Theory, tr. Wiener, 1954.
PHYSICS ONLY. LOGIC AND MATHEMATICS EXEMPT.
- 1928 CARNAP, Der logische Aufbau der Welt. The construction of the
world from private experience. Topic 07's property; the
programme Strawson's basic-particulars argument makes unworkable.
- 1934 POPPER, Logik der Forschung. Eng. 1959. ACCEPTS the logical
point of Duhem-Quine and answers it METHODOLOGICALLY.
- 1936 BIRKHOFF AND VON NEUMANN, 'The Logic of Quantum Mechanics',
Annals of Mathematics. The FORMAL proposal: a NON-DISTRIBUTIVE
LATTICE. NOT yet the claim that logic is empirical.
- 1948 QUINE, 'On What There Is', Review of Metaphysics.
THE CRITERION OF ONTOLOGICAL COMMITMENT IS DEVELOPED HERE.
'To be is to be the value of a bound variable' is the standard
slogan for it. IT IS NOT FROM 'TWO DOGMAS'.
- 1950 STRAWSON, 'On Referring', Mind. PRESUPPOSITION against
Russell's ASSERTED existence-claim. PREDATES Individuals by
NINE YEARS - a PRECURSOR, not an application of descriptive
metaphysics.
- 1951 QUINE, 'Two Dogmas of Empiricism', The Philosophical Review,
JANUARY 1951. The web-of-belief / field-of-force passage is
SECTION 6, 'Empiricism without the Dogmas'. CITE THE SECTION.
- 1953 From a Logical Point of View - 'Two Dogmas' REVISED and
reprinted. Both dates are correct for different versions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/42: PROVENANCE RAIL, PART TWO - 1956 TO 1985

- 1952 STRAWSON, Introduction to Logical Theory. The dissolution of the problem of induction, CH. 9. Optional.
- 1956 GRICE AND STRAWSON, 'In Defence of a Dogma', The Philosophical Review. CO-AUTHORED. Spelling: DEFENCE.
- 1959 STRAWSON, Individuals: An Essay in Descriptive Metaphysics. BASIC PARTICULARS: PART I. PERSONS: CH. 3.
The phrase is in the SUBTITLE - quote the subtitle, it is exact.
- 1960 QUINE, Word and Object. Radical translation, gavagai, stimulus meaning, analytical hypotheses: CH. 2.
EPIGRAPH: NEURATH'S BOAT.
- 1962 STRAWSON, 'Freedom and Resentment'. NOT a printed limb.
- 1966 STRAWSON, The Bounds of Sense. The 'non-sequitur of numbing grossness' charge against Kant's Second Analogy. Safe verbatim; Strawson's own phrase. Belongs mainly to Topic 04.
- 1968 PUTNAM, 'Is Logic Empirical?' THE CLAIM that the DISTRIBUTIVE LAW should be revised on EMPIRICAL grounds. Reprinted 1976.
PUTNAM LATER ABANDONED THE POSITION.
- 1968 QUINE, Dewey Lectures, 'Ontological Relativity'.
- 1969 Published in Ontological Relativity and Other Essays - the SAME volume as 'EPISTEMOLOGY NATURALIZED'.
DO NOT DATE NATURALIZED EPISTEMOLOGY TO 1951.
- 1969 CHOMSKY, 'Quine's Empirical Assumptions', in Words and Objections. ATTRIBUTE the underdetermination objection to CHOMSKY, not to 'critics'.
- 1970 QUINE, Philosophy of Logic. 'CHANGE OF LOGIC, CHANGE OF SUBJECT' and the MAXIM OF MINIMUM MUTILATION.
- 1973 DAVIDSON, 'Radical INTERPRETATION'. Interpretation, NOT translation - the change of word marks the change of doctrine.
- 1985 STRAWSON, Skepticism and Naturalism. Transcendental arguments limited to internal, descriptive work. Optional.

THE DOGMA

There is a PRINCIPLED, NON-ARBITRARY line between

ANALYTIC = true by virtue of MEANING alone

SYNTHETIC = true by virtue of extra-linguistic FACT

WHY QUINE CALLS IT A DOGMA: the line cannot be drawn NON-CIRCULARLY.

|

THE TWO CLASSES OF ANALYTIC TRUTH - START HERE, NOT AT 'CIRCULARITY'

CLASS 1 LOGICALLY TRUE

'No unmarried man is married.'

True under EVERY reinterpretation of the non-logical words.

Quine GRANTS this class; it is not where the trouble lies.

CLASS 2 TRUE BY SUBSTITUTING SYNONYMS FOR SYNONYMS

'No bachelor is married.' Put 'unmarried man' for

'bachelor' and it BECOMES a Class 1 truth.

THIS class is the one that needs SYNONYMY.

|

THE QUESTION THAT DRIVES THE WHOLE PAPER

WHAT IS SYNONYMY? Three routes are available. Each returns to the platform it left. PANELS 8, 9 AND 10 TAKE THEM IN ORDER.

THE PROPOSAL

'Two terms are synonymous when one is DEFINED as the other.
The lexicographer defines bachelor as unmarried man.'

|

THE FAILURE

EXCEPT for FRANKLY STIPULATIVE definitions, a definition REPORTS a
synonymy that ALREADY OBTAINED in the language. The lexicographer
is an empirical scientist recording usage.

|

WHY THIS IS CIRCULAR - STATE IT PRECISELY

The circularity is in the EXPLANATORY ORDER, not in the sentence.
Definitions are not circular IN FORM. The objection is that a
definition PRESUPPOSES the relation it was called in to explain.

|

WHAT QUINE CONCEDES

Stipulative definition DOES create synonymy - by fiat, in a new
notation. It cannot ground the general notion for a language
already in use.

TRAP: writing 'definitions are circular' misstates the objection.

THE PROPOSAL

'Two terms are synonymous when they are INTERCHANGEABLE SALVA
VERITATE - swapping them never changes a truth-value.'

|

FAILURE (a) - OVER-GENERATION IN AN EXTENSIONAL LANGUAGE

'CREATURE WITH A HEART' and 'CREATURE WITH A KIDNEY' are
COEXTENSIVE, so they interchange freely - YET THEY ARE NOT
SYNONYMOUS. The test admits pairs it should exclude.

|

THE PROPOSED REPAIR

'Then demand interchange inside NECESSARILY (...).'

|

FAILURE (b) - THE REPAIR PRESUPPOSES THE TARGET

The language must already contain a NECESSITY operator whose
intelligibility, for Quine, rests on ANALYTICITY.

So the repair presupposes exactly what was to be explained.

|

SHAPE OF THE ARGUMENT

WEAK TEST -> lets in too much. STRONG TEST -> assumes the answer.

There is no setting of the dial that works.

THE PROPOSAL (CARNAP)

'Analyticity is DEFINED for an artificial language L by explicit
SEMANTICAL RULES. A sentence is analytic-in-L if the rules say so.'

|

WHAT IT DELIVERS

A LIST. We learn which sentences are analytic-IN-L.

|

WHAT IT DOES NOT DELIVER

The GENERAL explanatory notion. 'Semantical rule' is no clearer
than 'analytic'. We learn the MEMBERSHIP of a set; we do not learn
what MEMBERSHIP CONSISTS IN.

|

THE STRUCTURAL POINT

Relativising to L moves the problem, it does not solve it. The
question 'what makes THESE the semantical rules?' is the original
question in new clothing.

TRAP: treating 'analytic-in-L' as a successful definition of
'analytic' concedes the very generality Quine denies.

WHAT QUINE CONCLUDES

The AVAILABLE EXPLICATIONS FAIL to provide the clear,
NON-QUESTION-BEGGING boundary that logical empiricism required.

|

WHAT QUINE DOES NOT CONCLUDE

NOT 'All bachelors are unmarried' is FALSE.
NOT the word 'analytic' has NO USE in any language.
NOT from ONE missing dictionary definition that EVERY use of
'analytic' is unintelligible.

|

WHAT REPLACES THE DISTINCTION

HOLISTIC REVISABILITY replaces categorical immunity with DEGREES OF
PRACTICAL ENTRENCHMENT. Central statements are revised rarely;
peripheral ones easily.

|

CENTRALITY CAUTION - THE MOST MISSED CONTROL ON THIS SUB-TOPIC

Practical entrenchment EXPLAINS why logic and mathematics are
normally protected. IT IS NOT A REPLACEMENT DEFINITION OF
'ANALYTIC'. Presenting it as one converts a strength into an error.

GRICE AND STRAWSON, 'IN DEFENCE OF A DOGMA', 1956

- 1 The distinction is ORDINARILY INTELLIGIBLE: competent speakers agree on cases WITHOUT theory.
- 2 A distinction in good working order is not discredited merely because no REDUCTIVE ANALYSIS of it is available.
- 3 Quine sets the bar TOO HIGH - he demands a non-circular DEFINITION where what we have is a usable DISTINCTION.

|

QUINE'S REJOINDER

ORDINARY INTELLIGIBILITY IS NOT THEORETICAL LEGITIMACY.

Agreement in classification does not supply the principled ground on which the POSITIVIST MEANING-CRITERION and the LINGUISTIC THEORY OF NECESSITY were resting.

Compare: speakers once agreed in applying 'witch' / 'non-witch'.

|

THE STANDING DISPUTE - NAME IT, THEN TAKE A GRADED SIDE

The quarrel is about STANDARDS OF EXPLICATION.

DEFENSIBLE VERDICT: Quine strongly pressures the distinction's FOUNDATIONAL use while leaving room for more modest semantic or ordinary classifications.

THE DOGMA

Each meaningful statement has its OWN private stock of confirming or disconfirming experiences, so statements can be checked ONE AT A TIME.

|

RADICAL FORM

Every meaningful statement is TRANSLATABLE into a language of immediate experience, TERM BY TERM.

Historical exemplar: CARNAP'S AUFBAU, 1928.

|

ATTENUATED FORM

Give up translation. RETAIN the claim that each statement, taken alone, has its own range of confirming and disconfirming experiences.

|

WHY THE LABEL 'REDUCTIONISM' FITS - A CHEAP MARK MOST SCRIPTS MISS

The doctrine REDUCES the meaning of each sentence to a SET OF OBSERVATION SENTENCES. The name states the operation.

|

ONE OBJECTION DEFEATS BOTH FORMS

Both assume a SENTENCE-SIZED PARCEL OF EVIDENCE. Remove that and both collapse together.

THE CANONICAL SENTENCE - QUOTE IT EXACTLY

'Our statements about the external world face the tribunal of sense
experience NOT INDIVIDUALLY BUT ONLY AS A CORPORATE BODY.'

|

THE UNIT OF EMPIRICAL SIGNIFICANCE

NOT the TERM that programme had already collapsed
NOT the SENTENCE that is the dogma being removed
BUT THE WHOLE OF SCIENCE

|

WHAT IS AND IS NOT DENIED

DENIED that experience bears on beliefs ONE AT A TIME
RETAINED that experience bears on belief AT ALL

THIS IS WHY THE RESULTING POSITION IS STILL CALLED EMPIRICISM.

TRAP: 'Quine denies that experience tests belief.' The tribunal
still sits. It hears the SYSTEM.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 15/42: THE TWO DOGMAS ARE AT ROOT IDENTICAL

QUINE'S OWN ARCHITECTURAL JUDGEMENT

The two dogmas are AT ROOT IDENTICAL.

|

THE ARGUMENT

DOGMA 1 survives only if SOME statements are confirmed
INDEPENDENTLY OF EXPERIENCE - 'confirmed come what may'.

|

That contrast needs a CONTRAST CLASS: statements confirmed
INDIVIDUALLY by their own experiences.

|

DOGMA 2 supplies exactly that picture.

|

REMOVE DOGMA 2 -> DOGMA 1 HAS NOTHING TO BE A CONTRAST TO.

|

WHY THIS EARNS MARKS

It converts a LIST of two criticisms into an ARGUMENT with a
structure. It is the closing line of any 2024 Q4(c) answer.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 16/42: THE WEB OF BELIEF - THE STRUCTURE

SOURCE: 'Two Dogmas', SECTION 6, 'Empiricism without the Dogmas'.
THE MODEL: a WEB, or a FIELD OF FORCE, whose BOUNDARY CONDITIONS are
EXPERIENCE.

(o)	(o)	(o)	(o)	(o)	PERIPHERY: OBSERVATION
\	\		/	/	SENTENCES, in direct contact
\	\		/	/	with experience
[	physics, chemistry, biology	]			revised comparatively easily
	[mathematics]				revised rarely
	[LOGIC]				revised last; NEVER immune

WHAT THE PICTURE ASSERTS

Only the EDGE touches experience. The interior is connected to it
by inferential threads. A collision at the edge produces
RE-ADJUSTMENT INSIDE; the interior is not directly hit.

CAUTION: the periphery is OBSERVATION SENTENCES, NOT private
SENSE-DATA. Quine is REJECTING the sense-datum programme here, not
restating it.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 17/42: THE WEB - THE THREE REVISION OPTIONS

A CONFLICT ARRIVES AT THE EDGE. SOMETHING MUST GIVE. THREE THINGS
MAY BE DONE, AND EXPERIENCE DOES NOT CHOOSE BETWEEN THEM.

|

OPTION 1 REVISE A NEARBY PERIPHERAL BELIEF easiest

OPTION 2 REVISE A DEEP INTERIOR STATEMENT costly but
open in
principle

OPTION 3 PLEAD HALLUCINATION - revise the OBSERVATION

STATEMENT ITSELF always
available

|

WHY OPTION 3 MATTERS

It is what makes 'ANY statement can be held true come what may'
LITERALLY TRUE rather than rhetorical. Omit it and the famous
sentence looks like an exaggeration.

|

WHAT THE THREE OPTIONS ESTABLISH

Experience says 'SOMETHING HERE IS WRONG'.

Experience NEVER says 'THAT SENTENCE IS WRONG'.

The gap between those two sentences is the whole doctrine.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 18/42: THE TWO CANONICAL SENTENCES

SENTENCE ONE - THE 2025 Q4(b) QUOTATION

'ANY STATEMENT CAN BE HELD TRUE COME WHAT MAY, IF WE MAKE DRASTIC ENOUGH ADJUSTMENTS ELSEWHERE IN THE SYSTEM.'

THE CONDITIONAL CLAUSE IS THE DOCTRINE.

It names the COST, and the cost is what DISCIPLINES the choice.

TRUNCATING IT AT 'COME WHAT MAY' PRODUCES RELATIVISM, WHICH IS NOT THE DOCTRINE. This is the commonest way to fail 2025 Q4(b).

|

SENTENCE TWO - THE CONVERSE

'CONVERSELY, BY THE SAME TOKEN, NO STATEMENT IS IMMUNE TO REVISION.'

The EARLY essay extends this IN PRINCIPLE even to a LAW OF LOGIC, mentioning the proposed revision of the law of EXCLUDED MIDDLE as a means of simplifying quantum mechanics.

IT DOES NOT FOLLOW that every revision is equally rational, or that logic is casually abandoned.

|

THE 2025 PAPER'S WORDING, FOR REFERENCE

'We can affirm the truth of any sentence in our total system, in the face of whatever experience, just so long as we are prepared to make adjustments elsewhere.'

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 19/42: THE FOUR CONSEQUENCES OF HOLISM

1 NO SHARP ANALYTIC/SYNTHETIC LINE

Central logic and mathematics are highly entrenched and normally protected, but CENTRALITY MUST NOT BE EQUATED with a new definition of analyticity.

2 NO SHARP A PRIORI / A POSTERIORI LINE

All beliefs are revisable in the light of experience, even those remote from the periphery.

3 PRAGMATISM ABOUT THEORY-CHOICE

When revision is needed we choose on grounds of SIMPLICITY, CONSERVATISM and FECUNDITY - pragmatic virtues, NOT algorithmic rules.

4 PRESSURE ON POSITIVIST MEANING-CRITERIA

SENTENCE-BY-SENTENCE reductionist verification is undermined.
WHETHER A HOLISTIC VERIFICATIONISM SURVIVES IS A FURTHER QUESTION - the paper does not settle it.

|

STATE CONSEQUENCE 4 CAREFULLY. Saying 'holism refutes verificationism' overstates the result and invites correction.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 20/42: WHAT BLOCKS ARBITRARY REVISION

THE OBJECTION

'If EVERYTHING is revisable, science has no fixed point at all, and rational belief has no constraint. Is holism even coherent?'

|

THE CONSTRAINTS - NAME THEM, OR THE OBJECTION STANDS

PREDICTIVE SUCCESS revisions must keep the system predicting

CONSERVATISM change as little as possible

SIMPLICITY prefer the economical system

FECUNDITY prefer the system that generates results

MINIMUM MUTILATION Philosophy of Logic, 1970

|

THE EXACT FORMULA

NO STATEMENT IS REVISABLE BY NATURE, ONLY BY CHOICE - and choice has COSTS.

|

WHAT HOLISM DOES AND DOES NOT LICENSE

LICENSES the RE-ALLOCATION OF BLAME across the system

DOES NOT indifference to evidence, or the claim that all

LICENSE revisions are equally warranted

- 1 The testable claim is $(H \ \& \ A) \rightarrow O$
H = the hypothesis under test
A = the auxiliaries: background theory, INSTRUMENT THEORY,
initial conditions
- 2 Observation reports NOT-O
- 3 By MODUS TOLLENS all that follows is NOT $(H \ \& \ A)$
i.e. H is false OR some element of A is false
- 4 LOGIC DOES NOT SAY WHICH CONJUNCT TO REJECT. Evidence,
background knowledge and methodological virtues can still make
some revisions far more reasonable than others.
- 5 THEREFORE refutation is never conclusive against a SINGLE
statement - and, symmetrically, 'any statement can be held true
come what may, if we make drastic enough adjustments elsewhere in
the system'.
- 6 THEREFORE a reductionist criterion assigning each statement its
own confirming experiences HAS NO APPLICATION. This attacks
DOGMA 2 directly; it PRESSURES, but does not by itself refute,
every possible holistic verificationism.

|

PRESUPPOSITIONS - WHERE EVERY OBJECTION ENTERS

- P1 hypotheses generate predictions ONLY with auxiliaries
- P2 no fixed decomposition uniquely assigns every recalcitrant
experience to ONE sentence
- P3 theory-choice employs PRAGMATIC VIRTUES alongside evidence

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 22/42: DUHEM AGAINST QUINE - TWO NON-IDENTICAL CLAIMS

SCOPE	DUHEM (1906)	QUINE (1951)
	PHYSICS ONLY. Physiology and certain other sciences CAN test hypotheses more nearly in isolation.	ALL OF KNOWLEDGE. 'The unit of empirical significance is THE WHOLE OF SCIENCE.'
-----+-----		
LOGIC AND MATHEMATICS	EXEMPT. Duhem does not put them at risk.	INCLUDED. 'No statement is immune to revision', not even a law of logic.
-----+-----		
CHIEF COROLLARY	There is no automatic EXPERIMENTUM CRUCIS against an isolated hypothesis, since auxiliaries are also in play.	Confirmation holism and underdetermination pressure. The stronger claim of rival total theories equivalent under ALL possible evidence needs FURTHER argument.
-----+-----		
MOTIVE	Philosophy of physics; the practice of physicists.	The demolition of the SECOND DOGMA, reductionism.

=====

THE LABEL 'DUHEM-QUINE THESIS' IS LATER SHORTHAND FOR TWO NON-IDENTICAL CLAIMS. SAYING SO IS ITSELF A MARK.

CASE ONE - URANUS

Orbit conflicts with Newtonian prediction.

- > astronomers DO NOT abandon Newton's laws
- > they revise the AUXILIARY 'we know all the planets'
- > NEPTUNE IS FOUND. Le Verrier and Adams, 1846.
- > THE SHALLOW REVISION WAS CORRECT.

|

CASE TWO - MERCURY

Perihelion conflicts with Newtonian prediction.

- > the SAME strategy posits the planet 'VULCAN'
- > VULCAN DOES NOT EXIST
- > the correct revision was the DEEP one: GENERAL RELATIVITY, 1915.
- > THE DEEP REVISION WAS CORRECT.

|

WHAT THE PAIR PROVES

SAME LOGICAL SITUATION. OPPOSITE CORRECT RESPONSES.

NO RULE SAYS IN ADVANCE WHICH TO CHOOSE.

That is the thesis, HISTORICALLY DEMONSTRATED.

TRAP: citing NEPTUNE ALONE makes holism look like a recipe for saving theories. The PAIR shows it is a claim about the ABSENCE of a recipe.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 24/42: POPPER AND LAKATOS - THE REPLY THAT CONCEDES

POPPER - Logik der Forschung 1934; Eng. 1959

ACCEPTS THE LOGICAL POINT ENTIRELY and denies its SCEPTICAL USE.

Falsification is not an automatic logical process but a
METHODOLOGICAL DECISION.

Scientists agree BY CONVENTION to treat certain BASIC STATEMENTS
as unproblematic for the purposes of a test.

They FORBID AD HOC RESCUES that reduce a theory's TESTABILITY.

RATIONALITY IS PRESERVED BY RULES OF METHOD, NOT BY LOGIC ALONE.

|

LAKATOS

Develops this into RESEARCH PROGRAMMES with

a protected HARD CORE - not surrendered

a revisable PROTECTIVE BELT - where revision is taken

Duhem-Quine turned into a CRITERION OF PROGRESS.

|

TRAP TO AVOID

'Popper refutes Duhem-Quine.' HE DOES NOT. He grants the logic
and answers it with method. Misreporting this is a factual error
an examiner can check.

THE EARLY CLAIM (1951)

'No statement is immune to revision', applied even to the law of
EXCLUDED MIDDLE.

|

THE STRONGEST CANDIDATE - TWO ACTS, THIRTY-TWO YEARS APART

1936 BIRKHOFF AND VON NEUMANN, 'The Logic of Quantum Mechanics',
Annals of Mathematics. A NON-DISTRIBUTIVE LATTICE of
propositions. THIS IS A MATHEMATICAL PROPOSAL.

1968 PUTNAM, 'Is Logic Empirical?' THE CLAIM that LOGIC IS
EMPIRICAL - that the DISTRIBUTIVE LAW should be revised on
EMPIRICAL grounds. Reprinted 1976.

THIS IS A PHILOSOPHICAL CLAIM ABOUT THE FIRST.

NEVER WRITE 'PUTNAM/BIRKHOFF'. NEVER MERGE THE DATES.

PUTNAM LATER ABANDONED THE POSITION.

|

THE RESISTANCE - FROM QUINE HIMSELF

1970 Philosophy of Logic. 'CHANGE OF LOGIC, CHANGE OF SUBJECT':
anyone who 'denies' a law of logic has merely changed the
meaning of the connectives, so no genuine disagreement has
occurred. Plus the MAXIM OF MINIMUM MUTILATION.

|

THE HONEST VERDICT

HOLISM IS RIGHT ABOUT CONFIRMATION AND OVERSTATED ABOUT
REVISABILITY. The defensible position is DUHEM'S THESIS WITH
QUINE'S MOTIVATION. The LATER Quine is a poor witness for the
EARLIER Quine's most radical claim.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 26/42: EMPIRICISM WITHOUT THE DOGMAS

WHAT IS THROWN AWAY		WHAT IS KEPT
the analytic/synthetic		SENSORY EVIDENCE as the check on
boundary as a FOUNDATION		the system
confirmation of sentences		NATURALISM: philosophy is
ONE AT A TIME		continuous with science
a privileged class of truths		the demand that ontology be
IMMUNE to experience		answerable to the best theory

WHAT CHANGES

The boundary between SPECULATIVE METAPHYSICS and NATURAL SCIENCE becomes a matter of DEGREE.

Ontological questions are decided, like scientific ones, by the PRAGMATIC VIRTUES of the total system.

There is NO FIRST PHILOSOPHY standing outside science to certify its foundations.

THE LABEL, AND WHY IT MATTERS

The section title is 'EMPIRICISM WITHOUT THE DOGMAS'. The word 'without' does all the work: SUBTRACTION, NOT REPLACEMENT.

CALLING THIS AN INTERNAL REFORM IS SAFER THAN CALLING QUINE EITHER A LOGICAL POSITIVIST OR THE UNIQUELY PURIFIED EMPIRICIST.

NEVER WRITE: 'Quine rejected empiricism.'

THE PHRASE

'A METAPHYSICAL ARTICLE OF FAITH' is the 2018 QUESTION'S FRAMING.
IT IS NOT A VERIFIED VERBATIM QUINE QUOTATION.
DO NOT PLACE IT IN QUOTATION MARKS AS QUINE'S OWN FORMULA.

|

WHAT QUINE DOES SUPPLY - THREE CONNECTED MOVES

- MOVE 1 THE EXPLICATION FAILS. Kant's synthetic a priori presupposes a workable analytic/synthetic boundary; the circle of synonymy shows none is available.
- MOVE 2 HOLISM. Statements face experience as a corporate body, so NO BELIEF IS A PRIORI BY NATURE. Apparent apriority is greater CENTRALITY in the web - a difference of DEGREE.
- MOVE 3 NATURALISM. There is no first-philosophy standpoint from which a priori knowledge could be certified. To assert it is to take on trust what cannot be shown.

|

THE KANTIAN REPLY, AND THE REJOINDER

REPLY transcendental conditions of experience are not empirical hypotheses inside the web, so revisability does not reach them. Strawson's descriptive reading of Kant gives this some support.

REJOINDER that reasserts precisely the privileged non-empirical status in question.

VERDICT: Quine defeats a SHARP a priori/a posteriori boundary; a gradient of entrenchment survives; the framework question stays open.

SOURCE: 'ON WHAT THERE IS', Review of Metaphysics, 1948.
NOT 'TWO DOGMAS'.

|

THE CRITERION, STEP BY STEP

- 1 REGIMENT the accepted theory into perspicuous QUANTIFICATIONAL FORM.
- 2 READ OFF the entities that must lie in the RANGES OF THE BOUND VARIABLES for the theory to be TRUE.
- 3 THOSE are the theory's ONTOLOGICAL COMMITMENTS.
- 4 'TO BE IS TO BE THE VALUE OF A BOUND VARIABLE' is the standard SLOGAN. Treat it as a canonical summary, not as a guaranteed verbatim sentence.

|

FOUR CAUTIONS - EACH IS A MARK

- 1 A criterion of COMMITMENT, not a rule for CHOOSING an ontology.
- 2 NOT surface word-counting: names can be PARAPHRASED AWAY, and apparently name-free quantification can carry commitment.
- 3 'TASTE FOR DESERT LANDSCAPES' = PARSIMONY, not nominalism at any cost. Quine accepts abstract entities where the best regimented science INDISPENSABLY quantifies over them.
- 4 The INDISPENSABILITY ARGUMENT is associated with QUINE AND PUTNAM together, not with the slogan alone.

|

THE OBJECTION, CONCEDED BY DESIGN

Rival PARAPHRASES display different commitments -> the criterion is applied AFTER theory and regimentation are chosen. It AUDITS; it does not CHOOSE.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 29/42: RADICAL TRANSLATION - THE EVIDENCE AND THE TERMS

SOURCE: WORD AND OBJECT, 1960, CH. 2. Epigraph: NEURATH'S BOAT.

THE SITUATION: a field linguist enters a community whose language has no known relation to any other. NO dictionary. NO bilingual informant. NO shared script. The only evidence is WHAT SPEAKERS ARE EXPOSED TO and WHAT THEY ASSENT TO OR DISSENT FROM.

|

THE EXACT PRINTED SUBTERMS - EACH IS A DISTINCT DEVICE

STIMULUS MEANING	the class of stimulations that would prompt ASSENT to a sentence, paired with the class that would prompt DISSENT
OCCASION SENTENCE	assent commanded only when FRESHLY PROMPTED ('Gavagai', 'It's raining')
STANDING SENTENCE	assent PERSISTS without prompting ('Copper conducts electricity')
OBSERVATION SENTENCE	an occasion sentence whose stimulus meaning is CONSTANT ACROSS SPEAKERS of the community - THE ONLY PLACE TRANSLATION IS SECURE
ANALYTICAL HYPOTHESES	the linguist's posited segmentation of native sentences into words and grammatical apparatus, projected BEYOND the observational base. THESE ARE NOT DETERMINED BY ANY EVIDENCE.

|

STATUS: BOUNDED ENRICHMENT. Taught in full; used only AFTER the two-dogmas and holism burden is discharged.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 30/42: GAVAGAI - THE NINE-STEP ARGUMENT

- 1 A rabbit runs past; the native utters 'GAVAGAI'. The linguist notes assent under rabbit-stimulation and records 'RABBIT'.
- 2 The SAME stimulus meaning is equally compatible with
'UNDETACHED RABBIT-PARTS' - wherever a rabbit is, they are
'A TEMPORAL STAGE OF A RABBIT' - likewise co-extensive
'RABBITHOOD' - an instantiation of the universal
'IT'S RABBITING' - a feature-placing sentence with NO OBJECT
- 3 Could he simply ASK, 'is this gavagai the same as that one?'
NO. That question requires him to have ALREADY TRANSLATED the
IDENTITY PREDICATE, the articles, plurals and quantifiers - the
entire APPARATUS OF INDIVIDUATION, which differs across languages
and is EXACTLY WHAT IS IN DISPUTE.
- 4 Any evidence he collects can be ACCOMMODATED by COMPENSATING
ADJUSTMENTS: a different translation of 'gavagai' offset by a
different translation of 'same'. The two manuals predict
IDENTICAL behaviour throughout.
- 5 THEREFORE INSCRUTABILITY OF REFERENCE: behavioural evidence does
not uniquely determine whether a term refers to rabbits,
undetached rabbit parts or rabbit stages.
- 6 Extending upward from TERMS to SENTENCES, rival ANALYTICAL
HYPOTHESES generate manuals that agree on ALL observation
sentences yet translate theoretical and non-observational
sentences into NON-EQUIVALENT English.
- 7 THEREFORE INDETERMINACY OF TRANSLATION: incompatible manuals can
fit the total behavioural evidence without a further
meaning-fact selecting one.
- 8 THEREFORE there are no determinate MEANINGS as entities; SYNONYMY
has no behavioural anchor; and DOGMA ONE'S KEY NOTION IS LEFT
WITHOUT FOUNDATION. Gavagai is the CONSTRUCTIVE COMPLETION of
'Two Dogmas'.
- 9 ONTOLOGICAL RELATIVITY is the broader thesis that reference is
specified RELATIVE TO A BACKGROUND THEORY. Keep it distinct from
the 1948 criterion of commitment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 31/42: TAXONOMY CONTROL - FOUR DOCTRINES, FOUR UNITS

DOCTRINE	UNIT AT ISSUE	CLAIM
RADICAL TRANSLATION	method/situation	translation built from publicly available evidence with no prior dictionary
INDETERMINACY OF TRANSLATION	sentences / MANUALS	incompatible manuals can preserve the TOTAL evidence
INSCRUTABILITY OF REFERENCE	SUB-SENTENTIAL TERMS	reference can vary under compensating changes in the individuation apparatus
ONTOLOGICAL RELATIVITY	FRAMEWORKS	reference is fixed only RELATIVE TO a background theory

=====

KEEP THE 1948 CRITERION OUT OF THIS TABLE. It asks what a REGIMENTED THEORY QUANTIFIES OVER. Relativity asks RELATIVE TO WHAT reference itself is fixed. Two questions, two dates, two jobs.

TRAP: using 'indeterminacy' and 'inscrutability' interchangeably.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 32/42: OBJECTIONS TO INDETERMINACY, AND THE PREMISES

THE PREMISES - STATE THEM; EVERY OBJECTION ENTERS HERE

- P1 BEHAVIOURISM ABOUT THE EVIDENCE. Quine's own formulation: in psychology one may or may not be a behaviourist, but IN LINGUISTICS ONE HAS NO CHOICE, since language is learned wholly from publicly observable behaviour.
- P2 THE EVIDENTIAL STEP. The move from total behavioural equivalence to 'NO FURTHER FACT' is a SUBSTANTIVE QUINEAN COMMITMENT, not a neutral consequence every holist accepts.
- P3 NATURALISM. There is no first-philosophy standpoint from which to certify meanings; physics fixes what facts there are.

|

OBJECTION -> REPLY -> RESIDUAL

CHOMSKY 1969 indeterminacy is merely ORDINARY UNDERDETERMINATION; if that does not make physics factless, why translation?

REPLY: in physics there IS a fact our theories imperfectly track; in translation there is NOTHING BEYOND DISPOSITIONS to verbal behaviour for a manual to be right about.

RESIDUAL: whether the ASYMMETRY can be defended without begging the question is THE central dispute. NAME IT AND TAKE A SIDE.

SEARLE; EVANS applied reflexively it entails that I DO NOT DETERMINATELY KNOW WHAT I MEAN by my own words.

REPLY: Quine accepts a version - at home we ACQUIESCE IN OUR MOTHER TONGUE; the first-person case has no privileged status, only a DEFAULT one. RESIDUAL: many find the bullet too large.

CHOMSKY, INNATENESS universal grammar would cut down the space of admissible manuals.

REPLY: the residual manuals would still be behaviourally equivalent; innateness RESTRICTS CANDIDATES, it does not CREATE A FACT OF THE MATTER. RESIDUAL: genuinely open.

DAVIDSON 1973 radical INTERPRETATION shows more determinacy once CHARITY and a TRUTH-THEORY are built in.

REPLY/POSITION: Davidson ACCEPTS indeterminacy but confines it to something like a choice of MEASUREMENT SCALE - Fahrenheit against Celsius - real but harmless. THE MOST INFLUENTIAL SOFTENING.

DATES FIRST: DEWEY LECTURES 1968; VOLUME 1969, WHICH ALSO CONTAINS
'EPISTEMOLOGY NATURALIZED'. NEVER DATE EITHER TO 1951.

|

ONTOLOGICAL RELATIVITY

THESIS what a term refers to is settled only RELATIVE TO a
background theory or translation manual.

ROUTE inscrutability generalised: to specify the reference of a
term you must use ANOTHER language, whose reference is
fixed only relative to a further background - a REGRESS.

STOPPING in practice we ACQUIESCE IN OUR MOTHER TONGUE and take its
POINT reference at face value. A DEFAULT, not a privilege.

|

NATURALIZED EPISTEMOLOGY

THESIS epistemology becomes a chapter of empirical psychology:
the scientific study of how MEAGRE SENSORY INPUT yields
TORRENTIAL THEORETICAL OUTPUT.

MOTIVE the collapse of the Cartesian and Carnapian foundational
projects. If the world cannot be RATIONALLY
RECONSTRUCTED from experience, the remaining question is
HOW THE CONSTRUCTION IS IN FACT ACHIEVED.

IMAGE NEURATH'S BOAT - we are sailors who must rebuild the ship
ON THE OPEN SEA; there is NO DRY DOCK.
The epigraph of Word and Object, 1960.

|

THE NORMATIVITY OBJECTION

A causal story about how belief is ACQUIRED appears to replace
'What OUGHT one to believe?' with 'How is belief PRODUCED?'

QUINE'S REPLY

Prediction, truth-seeking and method-selection can be studied and
improved FROM WITHIN science - a naturalized normative ENGINEERING
of inquiry.

THE RESIDUAL - CONCEDE IT

Continuity with science BLOCKS FIRST PHILOSOPHY but does not by
itself DERIVE epistemic norms from causal facts.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 34/42: THE QUINE CRITICISM LEDGER - WRITE THE THIRD COLUMN

OBJECTION	REPLY	RESIDUAL
GRICE AND STRAWSON 1956: pre-theoretically clear; we CAN sort cases	the PHILOSOPHICAL WORK done by the distinction collapses without a principled ground	a live debate about STANDARDS OF EXPLICATION
ANALYTICITY SEEMS REAL: 'bachelors are unmarried' differs in KIND from 'all swans are white'	he challenges its foundational EXPLICATION	web-centrality is not a full semantic REPLACEMENT theory
REVISING LOGIC IS EXTREME: has anyone ever done it?	quantum logic: 1936 formal proposal; 1968 empirical claim	the LATER Quine (1970) is a poor witness for the EARLIER Quine
HOLISM IS TOO EXTREME: if EVERYTHING is revisable, science has no fixed point	logic and mathematics revisable IN PRINCIPLE, held fixed in practice by conservatism	no statement is revisable BY NATURE, only by CHOICE
NATURALIZATION LOSES NORMATIVITY	method-selection and prediction ENGINEERED from within science	are truth-conducive norms EXPLAINED or merely ASSUMED?
COMMITMENT DEPENDS ON REGIMENTATION	correct - applied AFTER theory and regimentation chosen	the criterion AUDITS; it does not CHOOSE
INDETERMINACY COLLAPSES INTO ORDINARY UNDERDETERMINATION (CHOMSKY)	translation differs: nothing beyond behavioural dispositions	the asymmetry PRESUPPOSES the naturalism it is meant to support

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 35/42: QUINE AND LATER WITTGENSTEIN - BOUNDED COMPARISON

TWO TRADITIONS, NO DIRECT INFLUENCE, A STRIKING CONVERGENCE.

AXIS	QUINE	LATER WITTGENSTEIN
TARGET	the MUSEUM MYTH of meaning - words as labels on determinate mental objects	the AUGUSTINIAN PICTURE - words as names of objects
POSITIVE ACCOUNT	STIMULUS MEANING for suitable occasion sentences; theoretical language is HOLISTIC	meaning is USE within a language-game and a form of life
HOLISM	the unit is THE WHOLE OF SCIENCE	a word has meaning only within the PRACTICE
ANTI-FOUNDATION- ALISM	NEURATH'S BOAT - rebuild at sea, no dry dock	bedrock where 'MY SPADE IS TURNED' (PI 217)
REJECTION OF THE PRIVATE	indeterminacy permits nothing beyond public behaviour to fix meaning	the private-language argument shows nothing private CAN fix meaning
METHOD	epistemology NATURALISED	philosophy as THERAPY - description, not theory
WHERE THEY PART - DECISIVELY	Quine REFORMS language - a SCIENTIFIC account and REGIMENTATION into canonical notation	Wittgenstein DESCRIBES it and forbids theory: ordinary language 'IS IN ORDER AS IT IS' (PI 98)

=====

USE CAUTIOUSLY. The overlap pressures PRIVATE or MENTALISTIC fixers
of meaning. IT DOES NOT ESTABLISH ONE SHARED POSITIVE THEORY.
Wittgenstein's own doctrines belong to TOPIC 08.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 36/42: STRAWSON - DESCRIPTIVE AGAINST REVISIONARY METAPHYSICS

DESCRIPTIVE	REVISIONARY
describes the ACTUAL structure of our thought about the world	proposes a BETTER structure to replace the actual one
METHOD: CONNECTIVE ANALYSIS - show how concepts hang together; no concept analysed away into a privileged base	METHOD: RECONSTRUCTION from a preferred set of simples
STRAWSON'S OWN EXAMPLES: ARISTOTLE, KANT	STRAWSON'S OWN EXAMPLES: DESCARTES, LEIBNIZ, BERKELEY

THE RELATION - NOT MERE OPPOSITION

REVISIONARY METAPHYSICS IS IN THE SERVICE OF THE DESCRIPTIVE. It is instructive precisely because it shows WHAT IS LOST when a feature of the actual scheme is dropped.

WHAT THE PROGRAMME COMMITS STRAWSON TO

- (a) conclusions concern OUR CONCEPTUAL SCHEME, not a theory-free proof of mind-independent reality
- (b) the arguments are TRANSCENDENTAL IN FORM
- (c) an empiricist may ACCEPT the whole of Individuals as excellent CONCEPTUAL GEOGRAPHY while DENYING that it settles what exists. THIS IS THE STRONGEST REPLY AVAILABLE TO THE EMPIRICIST, AND CONCEDING IT STRENGTHENS AN ANSWER.

OBJECTION -> REPLY -> COST

CIRCULAR OR CONSERVATIVE: it protects the scheme used to state its own conditions -> the task is avowedly INTERNAL; radical revision and scepticism must BEGIN within some functioning scheme -> DESCRIPTION ALONE CANNOT PROVE THE SCHEME UNIQUELY CORRECT.

SOURCE: Individuals, 1959. The phrase is in the SUBTITLE.

FATAL ERROR: two definitions with NO EXAMPLES.

THE QUESTION - ASK IT PROPERLY FIRST

Of all the PARTICULARS we can identify and refer to - tables, persons, events, sounds, sense-data, numbers - which are ONTOLOGICALLY BASIC IN OUR CONCEPTUAL SCHEME, i.e. which are the items on which THE POSSIBILITY OF IDENTIFICATION AND REFERENCE IN GENERAL depends?

|

THE ARGUMENT (Individuals, 1959, PART I)

- 1 To IDENTIFY a particular we must DISTINGUISH it from other particulars and RE-IDENTIFY it across time.
- 2 Re-identification requires a SINGLE, UNIFIED SPATIO-TEMPORAL FRAMEWORK - one space and one time in which all particulars have locations.
- 3 MATERIAL BODIES are ENDURING, PUBLICLY OBSERVABLE occupants of that framework and provide the standard anchors for DEMONSTRATIVE identification and re-identification.
CAUTION: the framework is NOT a psychological image BUILT OUT OF bodies. It is a CONDITION of our scheme.
- 4 Many DEPENDENT particulars - experiences, events, sounds - are identified THROUGH their relations to PERSONS, BODIES, PLACES and TIMES.
- 5 THEREFORE MATERIAL BODIES ARE BASIC: presupposed by the identification of everything else, and not themselves identifiable only by reference to something more basic.

|

SUPPORTING - REFERENCE AND PREDICATION

Basic particulars are basic OBJECTS OF REFERENCE. The subject-predicate structure of ordinary discourse depends on IDENTIFYING something and then PREDICATING something of it. FEATURE-PLACING expressions such as 'It is raining here' need not identify a particular in full subject-predicate form, but they DO NOT REPLACE the framework through which particular-reference becomes possible.

TRAP: 'basic particulars = atoms or ultimate simples'. They are MACROSCOPIC bodies and PERSONS. NOT microphysical.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 38/42: WHY SENSE-DATA FAIL, AND THE PURELY AUDITORY WORLD

THE EMPIRICIST'S CANDIDATE: SENSE-DATA AS THE BASIC PARTICULARS

(Russell's logical constructions; Carnap's Aufbau; phenomenism)

THREE DEFECTS, EACH INDEPENDENTLY FATAL

DEFECT 1 PRIVATE -> cannot ground PUBLIC identification

DEFECT 2 MOMENTARY -> cannot be RE-IDENTIFIED

DEFECT 3 NON-SPATIAL -> lack the spatial relations needed to
CONSTITUTE a framework at all

THEREFORE material bodies are BASIC - NOT as a metaphysical
preference but as A CONDITION OF THE POSSIBILITY OF REFERENCE.

|

THE PURELY AUDITORY WORLD - THE REMOVAL TEST

SET-UP a scheme containing ONLY sounds: pitch, timbre, loudness
and TEMPORAL SUCCESSION. No space. No bodies.

PROBLEM objective re-identification needs to distinguish 'the
SAME particular encountered again' from 'a NEW particular
exactly resembling the first'. Qualitative similarity
alone cannot do this.

RESULT a world of pitch and succession alone does NOT YET
support robust objective re-identification.
STRAWSON'S DISCUSSION DOES NOT SIMPLY PROVE AN AUDITORY
SCHEME IMPOSSIBLE. Objective reference would require an
ANALOGUE OF SPACE - often reconstructed through a
continuously available MASTER-SOUND - that can organise
sounds into a public-like framework.

SUPPORTS the need for a framework performing the INDIVIDUATING
ROLE that space performs in OUR scheme.

DOES NOT that every conceivable scheme must contain visual and
PROVE tactile material bodies EXACTLY LIKE OURS.

|

WHAT KIND OF ARGUMENT THIS IS

NOT a proof of the external world (contrast Moore).

NOT a causal or scientific claim about perception.

TRANSCENDENTAL IN FORM, in a Kantian spirit: from our PRACTICE of
objective identification to the CONDITIONS of that practice.

CONCLUSION about the STRUCTURE OF OUR CONCEPTUAL SCHEME.

THIS PANEL IS THE EVALUATIVE CORE OF 2020 Q3(b).

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 39/42: STRAWSON - PERSONS AS A PRIMITIVE CONCEPT

THE THREE POSITIONS ON THE TABLE (Individuals, 1959, CH. 3)

CARTESIAN DUALISM	two substances; experiences belong to an IMMATERIAL SOUL
NO-OWNERSHIP / NO-SUBJECT THEORY	experiences are CAUSALLY DEPENDENT on a body but are NOT literally POSSESSED by a person
PERSON AS PRIMITIVE	the concept is LOGICALLY PRIMITIVE - not analysable into body plus mind

|

THE PREDICATE MATRIX - BOTH CLASSES ON ONE SUBJECT

M-PREDICATES (material) also applicable to MERE BODIES

'weighs 70 kg' | 'is in the kitchen' | 'has brown hair'

P-PREDICATES (personal) ascribing STATES OF CONSCIOUSNESS

'is in pain' | 'is thinking of Vienna' | 'believes it will rain'
| 'intends to leave'

A PERSON IS NOT A BODY TO WHICH A MIND IS ATTACHED. It is a single concept of an entity that is EQUALLY the subject of both.

'THE CONCEPT OF A PERSON IS LOGICALLY PRIOR TO THAT OF AN INDIVIDUAL CONSCIOUSNESS.'

|

THE ARGUMENT - SELF-ASCRPTION REQUIRES OTHER-ASCRPTION

- 1 I ascribe experiences to MYSELF: 'I am in pain.'
- 2 A NECESSARY CONDITION is that I can ascribe predicates of the same general kinds to OTHERS.
- 3 Others are identified as EMBODIED SUBJECTS, and psychological predicates are other-ascribed on PUBLICLY AVAILABLE BEHAVIOURAL AND SITUATIONAL CRITERIA. NOT a simple inference from bodily movements to a hidden Cartesian mind.
- 4 But P-predicates must ALSO be self-ascribable WITHOUT OBSERVATION.
- 5 This DUAL CHARACTER belongs to PREDICATES OF PERSONS.
- 6 THEREFORE the concept of a person is LOGICALLY PRIMITIVE. This is CONCEPTUAL PRIORITY, not the postulation of a third Cartesian substance.

|

THE TWO-WAY IMPOSSIBILITY - WHY IT IS AN ARGUMENT, NOT A STIPULATION

From a PURE CONSCIOUSNESS you never reach public criteria.

From a PURE BODY you never reach ascription without observation.

ONLY A SUBJECT THAT IS ALREADY BOTH SATISFIES BOTH CONDITIONS.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 40/42: THE TWO RIVALS DESTROYED, AND THE EXACT VERDICT

CARTESIAN DUALISM - TWO FAILURES

IDENTIFICATION how do we ever IDENTIFY or RE-IDENTIFY an immaterial soul? We cannot locate it in space, and identification requires ONE framework.

INTERACTION once the substances are separated, their commerce becomes unintelligible.

STRAWSON'S MOVE he does NOT ask how mind and body interact; he shows that THE QUESTION PRESUPPOSES A PRIOR UNITY THAT NEITHER TERM CAN SUPPLY.

|

NO-OWNERSHIP - SELF-REFUTATION IN ONE MOVE

To state the thesis the theorist must specify WHICH experiences.

He says: 'ALL THE EXPERIENCES THAT ARE HAD BY THIS BODY'.

'HAD BY' IS A POSSESSIVE RELATION. Contingent causal dependence cannot replace it, because dependence does not single out THESE experiences rather than any others.

HE THEREFORE RECONSTRUCTS THE PERSONAL FRAMEWORK HE SET OUT TO AVOID. (The view is traced through SCHLICK and Wittgenstein-influenced writers, and RECONSTRUCTED AND CRITICISED by Strawson.)

|

THE EXACT VERDICT - WRITE THIS, NOT MORE

DUALISM treats independently identifiable mind and body as conceptually prior. Strawson's analysis UNDERCUTS THAT STARTING POINT; it does NOT by itself prove every metaphysical dualist thesis false.

NO-OWNERSHIP eliminates the person while relying on a UNIQUELY RELEVANT BODY and a class of experiences; it RECONSTRUCTS the framework it tried to avoid.

OVERALL the mind-body problem is DISSOLVED rather than SOLVED: the decomposition that generates it is ILLICIT.

THE COST 'PRIMITIVE' MARKS THE END OF ANALYSIS RATHER THAN AN EXPLANATION of the psychophysical unity - legitimate for descriptive metaphysics, unsatisfying for anybody who wanted the problem SOLVED.

TRAP: refuting ONLY dualism. The chapter turns on the SECOND rival.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 41/42: THE ANSWER-WRITING SPINE, PART ONE

STEP 1 DECIDE THE OWNER FROM THE STEM

two dogmas | analytic | synthetic | reductionism | web of belief |
affirm any sentence | a priori as article of faith | empiricism
without the dogmas QUINE
basic particulars | material bodies | spatio-temporal | person |
primitive concept | mind-body dualism | descriptive
metaphysics STRAWSON
'critique of empiricism' with no further signal QUINE LEADS;
Strawson enters as ONE bounded paragraph, never as co-author.

|

STEP 2 DECODE THE DIRECTIVE - AND AVOID ITS FATAL ERROR

EXPLAIN THE THEORY OF BASIC PARTICULARS -> an ARGUMENT FROM
IDENTIFICATION. FATAL: listing what a basic particular is.
DISCUSS THE THEORY OF PERSONS -> the PRIMITIVENESS argument against
TWO rivals. FATAL: refuting only dualism.
EVALUATE THE ROLE OF SPATIO-TEMPORAL THINKING -> REMOVE space and
see what fails. FATAL: describing space and time.
COMMENT ON THE QUOTATION -> the CONDITIONAL CLAUSE is the doctrine;
modus tollens, then Neptune/Vulcan. FATAL: quoting the first
half and calling it relativism.
EXAMINE THE ANALYTIC/SYNTHETIC DISTINCTION -> the failed
explications as a CHAIN. FATAL: inferring from one missing
definition that nothing can be called analytic.
DISTINGUISH DESCRIPTIVE FROM REVISIONARY -> give STRAWSON'S OWN
EXAMPLES. FATAL: two definitions with no examples.
CRITICALLY / EVALUATE / DO YOU AGREE -> a GRADED VERDICT.
FATAL: a balanced summary with no ruling.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 42/42: THE ANSWER-WRITING SPINE, PART TWO

STEP 3 RUN THE SPINE

QUINE dogma 1 (circle) -> dogma 2 (reductionism) -> holism
(web + both quotations) -> Duhem-Quine (modus tollens,
Neptune/Vulcan) -> limits (minimum mutilation, 1970) ->
verdict (empiricism reformed, not abandoned)

STRAWSON descriptive vs revisionary -> identification needs
re-identification needs ONE framework -> sense-data are
private, momentary, non-spatial -> MATERIAL BODIES BASIC
-> persons: M + P predicates on ONE thing ->
self-ascription requires other-ascription -> dualism AND
no-ownership both presuppose what they deny -> verdict

|

STEP 4 CLOSE WITH THE QUALIFICATION THAT LIFTS THE ANSWER

QUINE the result is the FAILURE OF AN EXPLICATION, not the
claim that 'all bachelors are unmarried' is false.

STRAWSON the result is about OUR CONCEPTUAL SCHEME; an empiricist
can accept the whole of Individuals as conceptual
geography while denying that it settles what exists.
CONCEDING THIS STRENGTHENS THE ANSWER.

|

FOUR CHEAP MARKS

cite 'Two Dogmas' to SECTION 6 | date the bound-variable slogan to
1948 | name GRICE alongside Strawson | quote the SUBTITLE of
Individuals

NEVER WRITE

'Quine rejected empiricism' | 'Strawson defended empiricism' |
'Duhem and Quine hold the same thesis' | 'Quine denied meaning
tout court' | 'Putnam/Birkhoff' | 'basic particulars are atoms' |
'person is primitive = dualism'

=====

END OF ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM - 42 PANELS

=====